

WALTER OKUMU ORIARO

HEAD OF CUSTOMER SUCCESS & TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Dual-mandate technology executive leading customer success operations and web development architecture across 7 countries. Currently managing 12 direct reports spanning graphic design, customer success, web development, SEO, and IT support while maintaining hands-on responsibility for API architecture and technical infrastructure. Proven track record of bridging technical excellence with business outcomes, delivering 40% improvement in customer satisfaction through integrated technical and customer success strategies.

Key Leadership Metrics: • 12 Direct Reports Across 7 Countries • 40% Customer Satisfaction Improvement • 78% Deployment Error Reduction • 23% Upsell Revenue Growth • Full-Stack Technical Architecture Ownership

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

YELLOW PAGES GROUP | Nairobi, Kenya

Head of Customer Success & Technical Architecture | June 2023 – Present

Leading dual responsibilities across customer success operations and technical infrastructure for Yellow Pages Group's digital portfolio spanning Kenya, Tanzania, Mozambique, São Tomé, East Timor, Cape Verde, and Angola.

Executive Leadership & Team Management:

- **Built and manage a 12-person cross-functional team** across 7 countries including:
 - 3 Graphic Designers (Kenya, Cape Verde)
 - 3 Customer Success Team Leads (Kenya, Mozambique, Cape Verde)
 - 2 Web Developers (Cape Verde, Mozambique)
 - 1 Junior Web Developer (direct technical report)
 - 1 Copywriter, 1 SEO Expert, 1 IT Assistant
- **Coordinate daily operations across multiple time zones**, implementing remote management best practices for distributed team effectiveness
- **Serve as primary technical escalation point** for complex customer and infrastructure issues across the entire group

Customer Success Operations Leadership:

- **Designed comprehensive customer fulfillment operations** for all digital products, reducing time-to-value from 3 weeks to 5 days

- **Established proactive customer success program** resulting in 40% improvement in satisfaction metrics through personalized outreach and data-driven intervention strategies
- **Created integrated financial reporting system** tracking customer spend against revenue across all countries, identifying upsell opportunities that increased revenue by 23%
- **Implemented customer success metrics dashboard** enabling real-time monitoring and proactive issue resolution, improving retention rates by 25%

Technical Architecture & Infrastructure Leadership:

- **Architect and maintain core API infrastructure** serving digital products across Yellow Pages Group's entire portfolio, achieving 99.8% uptime
- **Led technical migration strategy** converting all Drupal-based websites across 7 countries to React.js/Next.js, personally solving complex SEO challenges that initially threatened site visibility
- **Designed and implemented enterprise CI/CD pipeline** using GitHub Actions and Docker, reducing deployment errors by 78% and cutting deployment time from hours to minutes
- **Oversee backend development operations** including database optimization, API endpoint management, and cloud infrastructure scaling using AWS (EC2, S3, RDS)

Cross-Functional Integration & Innovation:

- **Bridge technical development with customer needs** by translating customer feedback into technical roadmap priorities and leveraging technical insights to proactively solve customer challenges
- **Mentor technical team members** through weekly code reviews and pair programming sessions, enabling junior developers to tackle increasingly complex projects
- **Coordinate between technical and business teams** to ensure customer requirements drive technical decisions while maintaining system scalability and performance

YELLOW PAGES GROUP | Nairobi, Kenya

Senior Web Developer | November 2022 – May 2023

- **Spearheaded flagship platform migration** from Drupal to ReactJS across multiple countries, improving user experience and achieving 20% increase in page load speed
- **Architected scalable API backend** using Node.js and PostgreSQL that unified data management processes across departments and countries
- **Established CI/CD foundation** that enabled the company's rapid international expansion and technical scaling
- **Collaborated with international marketing teams** to implement SEO best practices, resulting in 30% increase in organic traffic within three months

MICROVERSE | Remote

Technical Mentor (Volunteer) | August 2022 – Present

- **Provide technical guidance and career mentoring** to aspiring developers from diverse international backgrounds
- **Conduct weekly code reviews and problem-solving sessions** for complex coding challenges, with three mentees successfully securing their first developer roles
- **Facilitate remote collaboration training** based on real-world experience managing distributed technical teams

MICROVERSE | Remote

Full-Stack Web Developer | May 2022 – December 2022

- **Completed 1300+ hours of intensive full-stack training** while mastering remote collaboration with international development teams
- **Developed expertise in algorithms, data structures, and modern web technologies** through project-based learning
- **Gained proficiency in remote pair programming** using GitHub, GitFlow, and daily standups—skills now applied in managing distributed teams

BRITISH AMERICAN TOBACCO KENYA | Nairobi, Kenya

East & Central Africa Area Systems Expert | February 2014 – June 2018

- **Transformed regional data accuracy from 40% to 95%** through systematic process improvements and team collaboration across multiple countries
- **Redesigned headcount management processes** creating dashboards that enabled data-driven workforce planning for regional operations
- **Participated in global process alignment project** collaborating with teams from South Africa, Romania, and United Kingdom—early experience in international team coordination

BRITISH AMERICAN TOBACCO KENYA | Nairobi, Kenya

Full-Stack Developer & Database Administrator | April 2012 – March 2014

- **Consolidated multiple workflow applications** into unified core system, eliminating data silos and improving cross-departmental collaboration
- **Designed travel management system** reducing processing time by 60% while generating significant cost savings
- **Created capital expenditure approval system** streamlining budget tracking and financial controls

KEY DIGITAL PROPERTIES MANAGED

Yellow Pages Group International Network

Primary Responsibility: Technical architecture, customer success operations, and team leadership across all platforms

- [Yellow Pages Kenya](#) - Kenya's #1 digital marketing agency providing comprehensive business directory, digital marketing, and web development services
- [Páginas Amarelas Cape Verde](#) - Official business directory for Cape Verde with digital marketing and e-commerce solutions
- [Páginas Amarelas São Tomé](#) - Business directory and digital services for São Tomé and Príncipe market
- [Páginas Amarelas Mozambique](#) - Comprehensive business directory and digital marketing platform for Mozambique
- [Páginas Amarelas Angola](#) - Angola's premier business directory and digital marketing solutions provider

- [Yellow Pages Tanzania](#) - Business directory and digital marketing services for Tanzanian market
- [Pajina Kinur East Timor](#) - Business directory and digital solutions for East Timor/Timor-Leste

Tourism & Travel Guide Websites

Role: Full-stack development, SEO optimization, and content management systems

- [Travel Discover Kenya](#) - Comprehensive Kenya tourism and travel guide platform with booking capabilities
- [Guia São Tomé](#) - Tourism and travel guide for São Tomé and Príncipe
- [Guia de Cabo Verde](#) - Cape Verde tourism guide and travel booking platform
- [Turismo Moçambique](#) - Mozambique tourism and travel information portal

Client Project Portfolio

Role: Technical leadership, web development, and digital strategy implementation

- [Rhodium Digital Signage](#) - Corporate communications and digital signage solutions across East Africa with enterprise-grade security and multimedia deployment capabilities
- [Cura Global Recruitment](#) - International healthcare recruitment platform connecting medical professionals with global opportunities across 25+ countries
- [Kua Wellness Africa](#) - Wellness and sound healing services platform with booking system and comprehensive service management

CORE COMPETENCIES

Executive Leadership & Strategy

- Cross-Border Team Management (7 Countries)
- Customer Success Operations Strategy
- Financial Analysis & Revenue Optimization
- Strategic Planning & Implementation
- Remote Team Leadership & Coordination

Technical Architecture & Development

- **Frontend:** React.js, Next.js, TypeScript, Performance Optimization
- **Backend:** Node.js, Express.js, RESTful API Architecture
- **Databases:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB
- **Cloud & DevOps:** AWS (EC2, S3, RDS), Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD
- **Testing & Quality:** Jest, Cypress, Code Review Leadership

Customer Success & Operations

- Customer Relationship Management at Scale
- Onboarding Process Design & Optimization
- Customer Success Metrics & Analytics
- Cross-Functional Process Integration
- International Customer Support Operations

Business-Technical Integration

- Product Roadmap Translation from Customer Feedback
 - Technical Solution Design for Business Requirements
 - Cross-Department Communication & Coordination
 - Revenue Impact Analysis from Technical Improvements
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KEY STRATEGIC PROJECTS

Multi-Country Digital Infrastructure Transformation

Led comprehensive conversion of all digital properties across 7 countries from Drupal to React.js/Next.js, addressing complex SEO and performance challenges while maintaining business continuity during transition.

Customer Success Operations Platform

Designed and implemented integrated customer success operations spanning multiple countries, including automated onboarding workflows, proactive engagement systems, and real-time metrics dashboards.

Enterprise API Architecture

Architected and maintain centralized API infrastructure serving all digital products across Yellow Pages Group's portfolio, enabling scalable operations and consistent data management across countries.

International Team Management System

Developed management frameworks and communication protocols for effectively leading distributed teams across 7 countries and multiple time zones while maintaining high productivity and team cohesion.

EDUCATION

MICROVERSE | May 2022 – December 2022

Full Stack Web Development Program (1300+ intensive hours)

CATHOLIC UNIVERSITY OF EASTERN AFRICA | August 2005 – October 2011

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science, Software Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microverse React & Redux Module (October 2022)
- Microverse JavaScript Module (September 2022)

- Scientific Computing with Python - freeCodeCamp (December 2021)
- React (Basic) - HackerRank (December 2021)
- JavaScript (Basic) - HackerRank (December 2021)
- Responsive Web Design - freeCodeCamp (October 2021)
- Front-End Web UI Frameworks: Bootstrap 4 - Coursera (April 2021)